

Composition





About the Course

Students build experience with multiple forms of writing and writing concepts such as dialogue, scene writing, point of view, outlining, various types of analysis, and more while honing their revision and editing skills with Williams' and Bizup's classic text.

This topic is included in the following course(s): Language Study: Grade 10

Composition: Grade 10

In addition to their composition and grammar lessons, students should continue to keep track of their regular written narrations and write 5-10 each week. Not all narrations need to be lengthy, but students should be comfortable typing multiple paragraphs if given the time.



Placement & Combining Tips

Prerequisite: Students with no background in the essay form should begin with Essay Voyage from the Grade 9 lessons.

Composition prompts often reference Alveary lessons in Literature, History, Geography, Bible, etc., so it is ideal if students are using Alveary subjects across the curriculum. However, lessons include the lesson topic and target skill/form, along with ideas for substitution when possible to make the lessons flexible for teachers and students.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
10	Composition: Grade 10 3 times/week 40 min	Style: The Basics of Clarity & Grace 5th ed.

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Language Study: Grade 10				
Grammar: Grade 10	Composition: Grade 10	Composition: Grade 10	Commonplace: Grades 9-12	Composition: Grade 10



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

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□ One purpose of composition lessons is to encourage you, the student, to dig deeper, self-reflect on your own thoughts and writing, and learn how to ask good questions of yourself and your readings. It isn't about proving to your teacher that you read a book or did an assignment.

□ Set the timer and use the whole time allotted for a lesson. If you finish an assignment with extra time, explore another perspective, ask further questions, or take a bit more time to see if any other thoughts come to mind. Alternately, if you find yourself stuck, you may want to take a short break and come back later or break up the time into two shorter times. Growth, not frustration, is the goal.

Term Prep & Teacher Tips

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□ Plan to have your student(s) type the majority of their narrations and compositions. See keyboarding course for resources on typing if needed.

□ Encourage students to spend all the time left at the end of a lesson on their written narrations and the whole lesson time on their compositions and give as much detail as possible. For their narrations, it may help if you encourage them to think of writing their narrations for a friend or someone who has never read the book, rather than for you, who might already know the story. If they feel like they've run out of things to write, have them try varying the type of narration they're writing (interview, sketch, letter, poem, etc.).



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

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Style: The Basics of Clarity & Grace 5th ed.



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

Composition: Grade 10

∞ [Basics of Clarity & Grace Answer Key](#)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Composition: Grade 10

How To Approach



Read

You will read books across the curriculum, including the text of Caesar's English II. Look for interesting quotes to copy into your commonplace book!



Discuss

Caesar's English is best discussed with a teacher to share in the joy of learning new words and understanding the history of our language.



Practice

You will practice many forms of composition over the year. Your books will often serve as the foundation for your assignments.



Teacher Note

- As you review your students' composition assignments, be sure to read the instructions in the lesson and give feedback and support accordingly.
- Some students naturally integrate and incorporate ideas from grammar and composition lessons into their narrations and composition assignments, but most assignments ask students to focus on one skill or idea.
- For editing or revision lessons, hold the student accountable to work through the process and instructions given for editing, but refrain from suggesting too many ideas about how they could expand the essay or add another idea.
- For assignments that ask a student to focus on a particular concept, ignore spelling or grammar edits, and support your student by noticing what they've done well and drawing out ideas on how to dig deeper.

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Term 1

WEEK 1

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 1

Tech/Visual

→ WRITE

Sometimes a "picture is worth a thousand words." Use this lesson to create an infographic by hand or in Canva, PowerPoint, or another design software. Look at some of the coffee infographics in the attached article to get a sense of the possibilities. Whether created digitally or by hand, visual illustrations are a powerful narration tool as well to help you understand what you read, so feel free to incorporate visuals into your daily narrations!

First, brainstorm what you want to illustrate. Here are some ideas:

- Show the process to conduct a science lab.
- Key events in your life or the life of a historical character you're reading about
- Outline a sermon you've heard or key points from a chapter in one of your books.
- Your daily or weekly schedule
- Your family tree
- Something else entirely!
- How to make your favorite recipe

∞ Article Link: Coffee Infographic

★ STUDENT/TEACHER NOTE

In addition to these more formal composition lessons, be sure to keep up the habit of written and oral narrations throughout the week. Aim for 8-10 written narrations per week, and use different ways of narrating to keep it interesting!

You may write or type your narrations and compositions initially. But for these composition lessons, be sure to type the final draft you turn into your teacher.

• REFERENCE

Poetry Study: Grades 9-12 (Lesson 1)

Book: Making of a Poem

WEEK 1

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 2

Questions

→ INTRO

Charlotte Mason said that we only know what we ask ourselves questions about and then can communicate to ourselves and others. She called all the different ways that we can narrate "forms of vitality." Here are her actual words:

One thing at any rate we know with certainty, that no teaching, no information becomes knowledge to any of us until the individual mind has acted upon it, translated it, transformed, absorbed it, to reappear, like our bodily food, in forms of vitality. Therefore, teaching, talk and tale, however lucid or fascinating, affect nothing until self-activity be set up; that is, self-education is the only possible education; the rest is mere veneer laid on the surface of a child's nature (Vol. 6, p.240).

This is how we know and why we narrate. We help ourselves along in this process by developing the habit of asking good questions. A famous scientist named Louis Agassiz was a master at helping students see and observe more by learning to ask themselves questions about whatever they were studying. Read the account of one of his students when first being examined for the opportunity.

→ READ & NARRATE

p.96-100 "The examination"- "knowledge of fossils."

∞ Website Link: Autobiography of Nathaniel Shaler

→ WRITE

Write as many observations and questions about one of your readings as you have time for.

WEEK 1

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 3

Editing

Materials: Style: The Basics of Clarity & Grace

→ INTRO

As you refine the craft of putting words together in a meaningful way, think about the purpose of your writing. Some types of writing are for you primarily—written narrations, your journal if you have one, notes on a talk, etc. Other times, we write for others as well—an email or text, a party announcement, a blog article, an essay for a class, a book. When composing something for another person to read, good writers frequently revise, edit, and rewrite their work to make it the best they can.

When writing for themselves, writers do not need to focus as much on whether words are spelled correctly or spend much time (unless they want to!) revising their sentences. But if they want to turn a draft of something into a piece of literary art or create something that others will read, they embrace the process of revising and editing their writing to make sure their writing is free from distracting spelling errors and clunky sentences. Editing is for others; it is a way for you to be hospitable as a writer, to make your readers welcome and at home. But it is also for you. As you revisit ideas, rewrite sentences, and reconsider the flow of your words, you will experience afresh the joy of language; you will ask new questions, make new connections, see new things. Writing is an adventure.

Style: The Basics Clarity and Grace will equip you with the tools to edit and revise your writing. Remember that the principles in the book do not apply when you are mostly writing for yourself, so don't get caught up in trying to write perfect sentences for all your written narrations (unless you enjoy that!).

→ READ & NARRATE

"Preface" p.vii-ix

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"Understanding Style" p.1-6

- Explain the difference between writing for you and writing for someone else.
- Why is editing and revision important to good writers?
- Have you seen or experienced a situation where someone neglected to revise or edit their writing before sharing with someone else? What was the effect?

WEEK 2

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 4 *Poetry*

→ WRITE

Compose a poem that tells a story (either one you made up or a retelling of something you've read). Use the epic convention of starting "in media res" or in the middle of the action. For instance, if you are telling the story of your day, start with the moment you looked out the window and saw a hawk eat a worm, not the moment you woke up.

Give your poem an intentional structure and label what it is (refer back to Making of a Poem from Grade 9 Poetry study for a list of forms if desired).

WEEK 2

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 5 *Inspection*

→ WRITE

Gather 3 of your favorite books from the term so far, and reread the first few pages of each. Where does each author begin? How do they draw you into the story? What details do you notice in just the first few pages that give you a clue to what time period you're reading about, who the main character(s) is/are, what the purpose of the book is, what the genre is, etc.? Write down your findings.

Think about a few of your other favorite books in general. What about them grabs your attention? Add to your findings.

WEEK 2

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 6

 Materials: Style: The Basics of Clarity & Grace

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.7-9 (stop after Principle of Clarity #1)

- Remember that The Basics of Clarity and Grace aims to help you discern how to improve sentences or discern when a particular type of sentence is best. None of the sentences in the book are grammatically wrong.

→ REVISE - ACTIVITY 1

Rewrite the sentences below to make the main characters subjects. (Check your answers in the Answer Key Appendix in Quick Links.)

- While a ball was traveling across the infield, a chance to score for the team was seen by Charlie, who stood at bat.
- The words which were invented by Shakespeare outnumber the flying machines invented by Leonardo da Vinci.
- While a kite was soaring in the wind, a moment of pure joy was experienced by Sam who held the string.

→ REVISE - ACTIVITY 2

With remaining time, pick an old narration (even from last year), and inspect your sentences. Do you tend to naturally follow this first Principle of Clarity? If not, rewrite a few of your sentences.

WEEK 3

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 7 *Revision*

→ REVISE

Pick a previous narration that is at least two paragraphs long to revise and rewrite. Your goal is not just to make your writing free of punctuation or spelling errors but to create a more polished version of your narration that you could share with someone to tell them about the particular topic you wrote about or chapter you read.

Big-Picture Revision

1. If you have not already typed your narration, do that now so you have a digital version to edit.
2. Are there other ideas you've had more recently that you'd like to add to your narration? Do that now.
3. Look at your paragraphs. Are they indented and focused around one idea each? Describe that main idea in one sentence and consider making that the first sentence of your paragraph.
4. Try moving your paragraphs around in a different order. What order do you think might make the most sense to someone reading your words?

Sentence Level Revision

1. Read your narration aloud and fix any grammar or spelling errors you hear or see.
2. Use Grammarly or another spell checker to find any other punctuation or spelling issues and fix

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Term 1

those.

3. Look for wordiness. Are there any unnecessary words? Do you have any sentences that are very long that you could make into two shorter sentences? Long sentences have their place, but usually, shorter sentences are clearer.

4. Review your sentences. Are main characters subjects?

Share your revised narration with someone.

WEEK 3

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 8

Point of View

→ WRITE

Write a narration as if you are inside the story and telling a first-hand account of what you're seeing! For instance, perhaps you're walking alongside Judge Dee, observing all the happenings in *Paradise Lost*, looking for Longitude with John Harrison, or visiting another character in history. You can write it as a diary entry and tell your thoughts as you walk around inside the story. Or you could write it as a travel memoir and focus on describing what is going on to your audience. In either case, tell things from your first-person perspective.

WEEK 3

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 9

Materials: Style: The Basics of Clarity & Grace

→ READ & DISCUSS

p.9-13 "now look" - "and readable"

→ ACTIVITY

Take the list of nominalizations below and identify the hidden verbs and adjectives. Check answer key appendix to check your work.

1. Resistance
2. Happiness
3. Action
4. Clarity
5. Performance
6. Strength
7. Possibility
8. Agreement
9. Development
10. Bravery

→ REVIEW

Look back at an old narration of yours, a news article, or a book you're currently reading. Can you find examples of nominalizations from verbs or adjectives?

WEEK 4

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 10

Poetry

→ INTRO

Have you ever heard of "found poetry"? Learn more with the article below.

∞ Article Link: Found Poetry

→ WRITE

Poets have used historical texts like William Bradford's History of Plimoth Plantation, newspapers, novels, and more to create found poems. The act of rearranging words, pulling words from different places together, and thinking about key images in a text is essentially a way to think more deeply about what you have read. For this assignment, just pick one passage from one of your favorite books as your source text. Use *The Scarlet Letter* if there isn't another book that comes to mind.

- Decide your selected passage (keep it short - no more than 1-2 pages).
- Highlight words or phrases you particularly like and/or which seem particularly important to the passage.
- Type or write those words on a separate piece of paper and use them to write a poem.
- You may choose whether to limit yourself to ONLY words found in your text or whether you want to add some of your own words as well.

WEEK 4

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 11

Essay

→ WRITE

Current Event: Pick a topic and research. Summarize the perspective of each side in your own words, including brief quotes from each perspective to support your summary. Hyperlink any articles you reference, as in a news article. Aim to give the best points from each perspective and imagine talking to a person who believed in each. Would they agree that you understand their perspective and have summarized it well?

Here is a sample outline of how your essay might end up, though you are free to use a different structure as long as you include each of the components. Work on the middle two paragraphs

• REFERENCE Current Events

★ STUDENT/TEACHER TIP

The purpose of this essay is to work on researching the conversation about a particular topic, articulating both sides well in your own words, and giving your thoughts. Try to choose a topic that interests you and will be relatively simple to research. For instance, a topic like whether a particular town should add a

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today. You will have three lesson periods to work on this essay.

- \- 1 short paragraph introducing the topic you're going to talk about and why you think it's important
- \- 1 paragraph explaining one point of view and the reasons for it
- \- 1 paragraph explaining the opposite point of view and the reasons
- \- 1 paragraph explaining which perspective you find most convincing and why

train line is a better topic for this assignment than something large and complicated to research, such as whether to vote republican, democrat, or third party.

WEEK 4

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 12

Materials: Style: The Basics of Clarity & Grace

→ READ & DISCUSS

"Diagnosis & Revision" and "Some Common Patterns." p.13-16

→ REVISE

Revise these sentences following the suggestions on p.13-16. Note: as you'll learn next lesson, some nominalizations are actually helpful. Give these sentences clear actions and characters, reduce or eliminate nominalizations, and discuss or share your sentences with your teacher or classmates. Possible revisions are also available in the answer key.

1. After extensive consideration of the committee's recommendations, the implementation of the new policy was announced by the board.
2. In light of recent developments regarding the environmental impact study, the suspension of construction activities was deemed necessary.
3. Following the evaluation of the project's feasibility, the decision to proceed with the next phase was approved unanimously.
4. Considering the potential benefits of the new technology, the adoption of innovative solutions was strongly advocated by the experts.
5. Given the significant rise in cybersecurity threats, the enhancement of protective measures has become a critical focus for the organization.
6. During the extensive training sessions conducted over the past month, there was a development of new skills among employees.
7. In response to the growing demand for digital transformation, the acceleration of the modernization of systems was proposed by the strategic planning team.

→ REVIEW

With extra time, pick an old narration, a news article, or another piece of writing to observe. Do you find short or long introductory clauses? Rewrite sentences with empty verbs, missing characters, and nominalizations.

WEEK 5

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 13

Essay

→ WRITE

Add to your current events project from Lesson 11. Today, develop your opinion on who has the stronger argument and explain why.

Here is a sample outline of how your essay might end up. Work on the first and last paragraphs today.

- \- 1 short paragraph introducing the topic you're going to talk about and why you think it's important
- \- 1 paragraph explaining one point of view and the reasons
- \- 1 paragraph explaining the opposite point of view and the reasons
- \- 1 paragraph explaining which perspective you find most convincing and why

• **REFERENCE**
Current Events

WEEK 5

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 14

Scene Writing

→ INTRO

Look at a Shakespeare play or another play that you have read and note the punctuation and formatting for writing a scene.

→ WRITE

Write a scene for a play based on the Celebrated Cases of Judge Dee OR The Scarlet Letter. The beginning might be the easiest section to use, but feel free to choose any section you like. You may want to use some of the actual dialogue in the book in your scene!

Bonus Idea: Give directions for any special effects (like music) that you would want as part of your scene.

• **REFERENCE**
General Literature: Grades 9-10 (Term 1)
Book: Celebrated Cases of Judge Dee OR The Scarlet Letter

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Term 1

WEEK 5

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 15

Materials: Style: The Basics of Clarity & Grace

→ READ

"Some Happy Consequences" and "A Qualification" p.16-18

→ WRITE & DISCUSS

Describe something you've read or experienced, and use as many nominalizations as possible. Then describe the same thing in another paragraph, and include only useful nominalizations.

- Which paragraph do you like better?
- Describe the tone of each paragraph.

WEEK 6

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 16

Tone & Style

→ WRITE

Have you noticed that books have a voice? Just as you can recognize a famous singer's voice when you hear a song, authors write in particular ways that establish their tone and voice as a writer, which we as readers unconsciously and consciously identify. We easily recognize this when a writer is angry or upset—this tone gets communicated by the words they choose, the number of exclamation marks (or sometimes all CAPS) used, and the way their sentences are structured—often short and punchy!

Think of a few of your favorite books. How would you describe the author's style or voice? Are there any words they tend to use a lot? Do their sentences tend to be long or short? Is their writing mostly description, mostly conversation, serious, funny? What kind of audience do they seem to want? It can be hard to pinpoint exactly what adds up to a writer's style, just like it's hard to imitate someone's mannerisms in real life. The best way is to simply try.

Today, pick a favorite author and try writing a narration (or you can make something up if you like) that mimics their style. After you've written a paragraph or two, read over it and think about it. Does it sound like the author you're trying to imitate? If not, ask yourself why not. Of course, your writing will never sound exactly like the author you're imitating, but it's fun to try!

One idea: try writing or rewriting a narration in Shakespeare's style!

★ STUDENT TIP

Experiment with writing in different authors' styles in your narrations, and pay attention to their tone!

WEEK 6

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 17

Editing & Revision: Current Events Project

→ WRITE

Now that your current events project has rested a bit, revisit it with fresh eyes and revise!

Big-Picture Revision

1. Are there other ideas you've had more recently that you'd like to add to your current events essay? Do that now.
2. Look at your paragraphs. Are they indented and focused around one idea each? Describe that main idea in one sentence and consider making that the first sentence of your paragraph.

Sentence-Level Revision

1. Did you link to the articles you drew from to learn about different perspectives?
2. Read your paper aloud and fix any grammar errors you hear and see.
3. Use Grammarly or another spell checker to find any other punctuation or spelling issues and fix those.
4. Give your essay a title (think of it like an article about a news event!).
5. Look for wordiness. Are there any unnecessary words? Do you have any sentences that are very long that you could make into two shorter sentences? Long sentences have their place, but usually, shorter sentences are clearer.
6. Look at your sentences and make sure characters are nouns and actions are verbs.
7. Check for nominalizations! Throw out any unhelpful ones!
8. Make sure your sentences are complete, not fragments.
9. Make sure your essay is consistently in 3rd person while reporting others' perspectives. If desired, you may switch to 1st person when talking about your opinions in the final paragraph(s).

Turn in your revised paper. Consider submitting it to a student journal!

WEEK 6

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 18

Materials: Style: The Basics of Clarity & Grace

→ READ & NARRATE

p.19-22 "Readers think" - "their actions."

→ REVISE - SENTENCE

Identify the characters and actions in this sentence.

"Societal use of pesticides has triggered the decline of pollinator populations, the disruption of ecosystem balance, and has now altered the patterns of plant reproduction."

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Term 1

→ REVISE - NOMINALIZATIONS

Turn these nominalizations into characters and actions.

- Scientific analysis
- Educational theory
- Managerial oversight

→ INVESTIGATE

Pick a current events article to read (a short one), and look for hidden characters.

WEEK 7

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 19 *Poetry*

→ READ (10 MIN)

Reread the opening lines of Milton's *Paradise Lost* and then read John Dryden's take on Milton in his opening lines of "State of Innocence," starting with Act 1, Scene 1.

∞ Article Link: [State of Innocence](#)

→ WRITE

Start writing your own poetic retelling of Milton's famous poem. Include any notes about why you chose to write it the way you did.

• REFERENCE

Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 (Term 1)
History of Lit (Lesson 7)

WEEK 7

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 20 *Details*

→ REFLECT

In addition to choosing sensory details to immerse their readers in a scene, authors have to choose which details (sensory and other) are most relevant to their story. As you read this week, notice the details authors include in their books and consider their significance. Sometimes small details lead to big conversations and insights. For instance, Matthew includes Rahab and Ruth in his genealogy leading up to Jesus's birth (Matthew 1). Most of the names he includes just move right from one to the next, but in a few places, such as this, Matthew pauses to give a bit more detail. Why?

→ WRITE

Describe a scene from *Longitude* or one of your history books (use 3rd person POV). Pay attention to the details you include. Work to help your reader envision the scene by including important sensory details (bonus if you can include details that reference all five senses—sight, sound, taste, touch, and smell). Write for the whole time.

• REFERENCE

Geography: Grades 10-11
Book: *Longitude*

WEEK 7

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 21

Materials: Style: The Basics of Clarity & Grace

→ READ & NARRATE

p.22-25 "Readers have" - "generic 'doer.'"

- Discuss this quote from your reading: "at the end of the day, a passage means only what careful and competent readers think it does." What do you think of this quote? Have you ever thought about sharing your writing with a few careful and competent people to see if they are able to discern what you are trying to communicate?

→ WRITE

Compose a paragraph about an abstract subject—perhaps you could describe the process for a science lab you completed recently. Describe your topic using characters rather than abstractions.

WEEK 8

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 22 *Questions*

→ INTRO

Why write questions? Questions engage our brains to think outside our current perspective and wonder about new ideas, new connections, and new perspectives that might not naturally occur to us. Another benefit of questions is that many books, essays, and other forms of writing (especially non-fiction) essentially exist to answer a question. As you read the news, articles, or other books, ask yourself, "What question does this piece answer?" For instance, a news article often answers the question: "What happened and what should I think about __ event?"

→ WRITE - GENERAL

Write 10 questions about a topic or book you're reading for Citizenship, Geography, Architecture, History, or Bible.

→ WRITE - HIDDEN QUESTIONS

Pick 5 nonfiction books or articles you have read this term (fiction can work too, but it is a little more tricky) and write down the questions you think are behind the book or article. Explain briefly why you think the book or article is an answer to this question. There may be multiple questions an author is considering, so just pick one you think is significant.

★ TEACHER TIP

If using these lessons in a group, have students share the questions they identified behind a particular book or article. Discuss the way that students may articulate the book's central question differently. The purpose is not to get a "right" answer, but to notice the commonalities and themes that multiple students pick up on, as well as the variety our perspectives bring to how we read and understand a book.

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Term 1

WEEK 8

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 23

Revision

→ REVISE

Go back to your descriptive scene from Longitude or a history book (Lesson 20) and revise.

Big-Picture Revision

1. If you didn't type your description before, do that now so you have a digital version to edit.
2. Are there other details you've learned more recently that you'd like to add to your description? Do that now.
3. Look at your paragraphs. Are they indented and focused around one idea each (Perhaps you have a paragraph focused just on sight, another on sound, etc., or perhaps you organize your paragraphs spatially and describe the immediate surroundings, the nature, the weather, etc.)? Describe the main focus of the paragraph in one sentence and consider making that the first sentence (topic sentence) of your paragraph.
4. Consider the flow of your description. Try organizing your paragraphs a few different ways and decide what you like best.

Sentence-Level Revision

1. Read your paper aloud and fix any grammar errors you hear and see.
2. Use Grammarly or another spell checker to find any other punctuation or spelling issues and fix those.
3. Give your description a title and put it at the top.
4. Look for wordiness. Are there any unnecessary words? Do you have any long sentences that would be better written as two shorter ones?
5. Look at each of your sentences (pull them out individually if that helps). Are they complete thoughts and not fragments? Do they have clear characters and actions?
6. Remove any unhelpful nominalizations.
7. For this assignment, make sure your description is consistently in 3rd person.

Turn in your revised description!

WEEK 8

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 24

Materials: Style: The Basics of Clarity & Grace

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.25-30 "More than" - "I or we."

- Describe the difference between a "technical grammatical" passive sentence and a "figurative impressionistic" passive sentence.

→ WRITE

Compose a paragraph using only active voice. You can write about one of your books, something you experienced, or make something up.

Then write a second paragraph on the same topic using only passive voice.

→ DISCUSS

Read both of your paragraphs aloud. Describe the feel of the writing in each.

WEEK 9

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 25

Plot

→ INTRO

How do authors keep you interested in a story or movie? Name as many ways as you can think of.

→ REFLECT

Reread the opening paragraphs of Ch.10 in The Scarlet Letter. What development in Chillingworth's character is described in the first paragraph? How does Nathaniel Hawthorne use this new information to move the story along? What questions or suspicions does he raise in you, the reader, with this intro?

Now look at the concluding paragraphs of Ch.10. How does Hawthorne build the suspense of the novel with the conclusion of the chapter as well?

→ READ & WRITE

Read the article on suspense and look for ways authors hold your interest and move their story forward as you continue reading The Scarlet Letter and your other books!

∞ Article Link: Building Suspense

• REFERENCE

General Literature (Lesson 11)

Book: The Scarlet Letter

WEEK 9

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 26

Character sketch or Expository essay

→ WRITE

Describe the ideal Chinese judge based on what you've read in Celebrated Cases of Judge Dee; include some examples from the book.

OR

Develop your discussion from the lesson and describe what you've noticed about medieval

• REFERENCE

General Literature: Grades 9-10

Book: Celebrated Cases of Judge Dee

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Term 1

Chinese culture and customs from this book.

When giving examples from Celebrated Cases, give the page number you are quoting.

The author shows Judge Dee as the ideal judge by highlighting his deliberate investigation. For instance, although Judge Dee does not think Koong looks like a murderer, he knows that he cannot make a decision "on the statement of this man alone" (p.11).

WEEK 9

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 27

Materials: Style: The Basics of Clarity & Grace

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.30-33 "When academic writers" - "researchers think."

→ REVISE

Reverse engineer these long compound nouns:

1. Childhood Learning Environment Evaluation
2. Sustainable Energy Production Technology

→ REFLECT

Look back over the first three chapters of "Style" and narrate some of the big ideas you want to remember as you continue to grow as a writer.

WEEK 10

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 28

Essay

→ WRITE

Develop your thoughts from the lesson. What are the different meanings of the chapter title "A Flood of Sunshine"? How does the imagery in the chapter support this idea?

OR

Whose view of sin and repentance is right, Hester's or Dimmsdale's? (First describe each of their perspectives on sin and repentance.)

• REFERENCE

General Lit (Lesson 19)
Book: The Scarlet Letter, Reflection Questions

WEEK 10

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 29

Dialogue

→ WRITE

Make up two characters (or pick two characters from the same or different books) and write a conversation including dialogue between the two of them. Here are some options:

- Have Judge Dee talk to Hester.
- Rewrite Adam & Eve's conversation in Book IX of Paradise Lost in modern-day English.

Save a few minutes at the end of the lesson and read your composition aloud. Does the dialogue sound natural?

→ A NOTE ON DIALOGUE

What makes dialogue move forward? Professor Lowry Pei gives this insight: "When people communicate perfectly, understand each other fully, agree on what must be done – conversation naturally ends. It is the imperfect understanding, the unfinished communication, the disagreement, the mismatch, the unfulfilled wish that keeps a dialogue going....While you're writing what the characters do say, be aware of what they don't say, but are thinking and feeling."

→ REVISE

Save a few minutes at the end of your lesson to quickly revise your work. Make sure to indent dialogue appropriately, read your writing aloud, and see if your dialogue sounds natural. Change it if it doesn't! And pay attention to dialogue in your books as you read!

• DIALOGUE

When writing dialogue, "keep your words and sentences short. Break up the speeches with the other person's questions, gestures, or thoughts. Start a new paragraph whenever the next person speaks, does something, or thinks. Short bursts of speech seem natural to the reader. Just as long speech paragraphs seem unnatural, so do long speech sentences. and so do long words" (from Writing Magic by Gail Levine).

• REFERENCE

Examples given from General Literature and Poetry Reading (Lesson 20).

WEEK 10

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 30

→ CATCH UP

Use this time to catch up on lessons in this or another course, or explore Extra Helpings.

WEEK 11

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 31

Poetry OR Illustration

→ WRITE

Write a narrative poem OR create a graphic novel style telling the story of "The Scarlet Letter."

Bonus Idea: If you write a poem, try including an epic simile!

• REFERENCE

General Literature: Grades 9-10
Book: The Scarlet Letter

WEEK 11

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 32

Revision-poetry

→ REVISE

Pick a poem you've written this term to revise. Revising poetry requires a different process than editing other types of writing. There are so few words in a poem (compared to a whole book or

★ STUDENT TIP

If you aren't comfortable reading your poem aloud to someone, consider just giving them a printed version of your poem. Let them read it and then either tell

Composition: Grade 10

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Term 1

essay) that it makes each word even more important.

1. Type your poem if you haven't already.
2. Revisit the rules of your poem's form (sonnet, sestina, ballad, etc.).
3. Read it aloud.
4. Does your poem follow the rules of its form? (Rhyme, meter, line count, etc.) If you are breaking any of the rules, decide if you are breaking them for a reason to make a point or if you need to find a different word or phrase to fit the rhyme scheme or meter. (Note: if you choose to break a rule, add a note about why this is important for your poem.)
5. Think about the flow of the ideas and images in your poem. Is there a better way to organize them?
6. Imagery and metaphor are important in nearly all poems. What images and comparisons does your poem use, and are there any others that might capture the image or idea even better?
7. Read your poem aloud again and look for any grammar or spelling errors to fix. Use Grammarly or another spell checker to assist you.
8. Jot down a few of the things you want your reader to walk away thinking or feeling after hearing your poem. Go read your poem aloud to someone (or two!) and ask them what their initial impressions are. If they are completely different than what you intended, consider what you might want to alter so that your purpose comes through more clearly.

you or give you a few impressions they've jotted down.

WEEK 11 **40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 33** *Catch Up Day*

→ **CATCH UP**

Use this time to catch up on lessons in this or another course, or explore Extra Helpings.

WEEK 12 **40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 34** *Exam Week*

→ **EXAMS**

Answer question(s) related to the course.

WEEK 12 **40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 35** *Exam Week*

→ **EXAMS**

Answer question(s) related to the course.

WEEK 12 **40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 36** *Exam Week*

→ **EXAMS**

Answer question(s) related to the course.

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Term 2

WEEK 1

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 37

Reflection

→ WRITE

Write down questions you have about writing. Where do you think you have improved? Where do you think you need to grow? What about writing is the most fun, most confusing, easiest, and hardest?

Discuss with your teacher.

WEEK 1

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 38

Essay

→ WRITE

Write about a current event (it could be a very local one, like the weather in your town) as though you are a reporter for a newspaper. Show your sources by linking to other articles you've read as you refer to them in your piece.

Think back to your question-asking assignment. What is the central question you want to answer in your article? Include this question somewhere in your piece (consider even using it as a title).

WEEK 1

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 39

Materials: Style: The Basics of Clarity & Grace

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.34-37 "If he" - "next easily."

- What did you think of the Benjamin Franklin quote at the beginning of the chapter?

→ REVIEW

1. Pick an older composition assignment to rewrite (for this assignment, don't choose a poem). Ideally, choose one that you have already edited or revised once.
2. Write or print off each sentence of your first two paragraphs on a separate piece of paper and mix them up (aim for 6-10 sentences).
3. Without looking at your original narration, move your sentences around like a puzzle and figure out what order produces the best flow. Feel free to also revise an individual sentence to help it fit better between the sentences before and after it.
4. Did you end up with your original narration, or did you find a better way to organize your thoughts?

★ TEACHER/STUDENT TIP

If possible, print off a few extra copies of your writing, create your sentence strips, and give them to two or three readers (you could choose a friend, a teacher, or a neighbor). Tell them the general topic of your writing, and ask them to arrange your sentences in a way that makes the most sense to them.

Compare the results! Any surprising discoveries?

WEEK 2

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 40

Questions

→ INTRO

Have you been pondering the questions behind the books or articles you're reading?

Take a few minutes to pick 3-5 of the new books or resources you've started this term and brainstorm the questions behind them. If the book is the answer, what is the question behind it?

→ WRITE

Spend the rest of the lesson writing questions about one or more of your books, an event, or a person you're interested in from this time period.

Types of questions you could ask:

- what questions (What was paper originally made out of?)
- why questions (Why didn't printing inventions make it to Europe earlier?)
- how questions (How did scribes learn to paint manuscripts?)
- where questions (Where was the first printing press located in the US?)
- when questions (When did scribes stop learning how to illuminate manuscripts?)

• WRITING CONNECTION

Consider the way that an essay or even just an individual paragraph is also an answer to a question. When you identify one larger question, the answer to that question becomes your thesis. The smaller questions that help you answer the larger question become the focus of each paragraph of your essay.

Whenever you are working to revise your writing and organize your thoughts, ask yourself, "What questions am I answering in this paragraph?" "What is the main question my whole essay or article is answering?"

WEEK 2

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 41

Beginnings

→ INTRO

When starting a story, authors have the daunting choice of deciding how to grab their readers' interest in the first few pages. Brainstorm a few different ways you've seen authors start their books. Here are a few common types of "beginnings" in literature to get you started. What other types of beginnings can you think of?

- "In media res" (into the middle of things)
- At the end (followed by flashbacks)
- With dialogue or conflict

→ WRITE

Pick a historical event or person you've read about. If you were going to write a historical fiction book, graphic novel, biography, or essay about them, where would you begin?

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Term 2

Brainstorm a few different ideas of places to start. Key events in a person's internal or external life often make good possibilities. Which do you think would draw readers in the most? Write your ideas down, then pick the best idea and start writing your piece for the remainder of the lesson.

WEEK 2

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 42

Materials: Style: The Basics of Clarity & Grace

→ READ & NARRATE

p.37-38 "In sentences" - "individual sentences."

- What do you think of the author's comment that "for readers, a passage's overall cohesion trumps the clarity of individual sentences"?

→ REVISE

Take your current events project from Lesson 38 and revise it, paying special attention to its overall cohesion. If desired, repeat your paper puzzle from Lesson 39 and revise this assignment the same way.

→ REFLECT

Do you find it difficult to think about flow in your writing? If so, that's perfectly normal. It can be very hard to think critically about your own writing because our brains fill in so much more information than is actually on the page. Try to approach your writing as if you hadn't seen it before and were not very familiar with the topic. Other ways to see your work with fresh eyes are to 1) revise assignments that are older, and 2) enlist the help of a friend who can tell you what they're getting or not getting out of what you've put on the page.

WEEK 3

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 43

Tone

→ WRITE

Have you noticed any mannerisms in the authors you've read this year (in school or on your own time)? Try writing (or rewriting) a narration the way one of your favorite authors would. When you're done, read your narration aloud to someone else and see if they can guess the author you're imitating!

WEEK 3

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 44

Revision

→ WRITE

Pick a previous narration that is at least two paragraphs long to revise and rewrite.

Big-Picture Revision

1. If you have not already typed your narration, do that now so you have a digital version to edit.
2. Are there other ideas you've had more recently that you'd like to add to your narration? Do that now.
3. Look at your paragraphs. Are they indented and focused around one idea each? Describe that main idea in one sentence and consider making that the first sentence of your paragraph.
4. Try moving your paragraphs around in a different order. What order do you think might make the most sense to someone reading your words?

Sentence-Level Revision

1. Read your narration aloud and fix any grammar or spelling errors you hear or see.
2. Use Grammarly or another spell checker to find any other punctuation or spelling issues and fix those.
3. Look for wordiness. Are there any unnecessary words? Do you have any sentences that are very long that you could make into two shorter sentences? Long sentences have their place, but usually, shorter sentences are clearer.
4. Make main characters the subjects of sentences.
5. Make important action verbs.
6. How well do your sentences flow? Put old information before new information in your sentences.

Share your revised narration with someone.

WEEK 3

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 45

Materials: Style: The Basics of Clarity & Grace

→ READ & NARRATE

p.38-41 "When you" - "they [readers]."

→ REVIEW

Pick 2-4 books you're reading this term, and read a paragraph or two in each. What are different ways you see these authors organizing their sentences?

• READING CONNECTION

When you are reading and something doesn't make sense, the first question to ask is "why?" Authors know that coherence and cohesion are important, so sometimes they will purposely disrupt their sentences with an unexpected sentence. This is an invitation to you, the reader, to ask why they might have chosen to do this. Perhaps the author is actually building a different type of coherence you hadn't noticed!

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Term 2

→ DISCUSS

How do you think this discussion of cohesion and coherence applies to fiction writing? How is flow different in a poem or a play than in an essay?

WEEK 4

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 46

Compare & Contrast

→ WRITE

Claudio and Hero are foils to Benedick and Beatrice, which means that readers can learn about each of them by seeing how they contrast with each other. Explain how the couples are different (include specific lines from the play to show the contrast).

Write in 3rd person.

→ REVIEW

- After you finish comparing and contrasting the two couples, write a thesis that sums up your analysis and put it at the beginning of your assignment.
- Read your writing aloud and fix any spelling or grammar errors you find.

Tip: If you're struggling to keep your writing in the 3rd person. Take out any times that you accidentally added an "I think" in your sentences to keep your writing from slipping into a 1st person point of view. The sentence will usually become a 3rd person POV sentence automatically if you simply delete the phrase "I think" from the beginning.

• REFERENCE

Plays/Shakespeare (Term 2)

Book: Much Ado About Nothing

WEEK 4

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 47

PowerPoint/ Google Slides

→ INTRO

A few times this year, you will have a chance to experiment with different ways to use technology with your writing. Today, you'll work on a presentation with PowerPoint or Google Slides. If you are unfamiliar with PowerPoint or Google Slides, you can google how to use it. However, often the best way to learn something is to simply dive in and learn as you go.

→ READ & NARRATE

Many people often use visual aids such as a PowerPoint to accompany a presentation. Slides don't include everything a speaker wants to say, just the key points to help an audience track and pay attention. Read these rules of thumb for presentations:

∞ Article Link: Rules for PowerPoints

→ CREATE

Keep the rules in mind as you create a brief presentation (4-6 slides is fine!) about one of these options:

- Three favorite things you've learned so far this year (and why they're your favorite)
- Why [Book] is your favorite
- How a science lab you did worked/the process of the lab and the results
- Introduce 3 significant historical characters or events all happening at the same time in the world

Have fun experimenting!

→ PRESENT

Plan a time to talk through your presentation with a live audience.

WEEK 4

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 48

Materials: Style: The Basics of Clarity & Grace

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.41-43 "It's hard" - end of chapter.

Review p.30-32 on Metadiscourse

- Have you ever noticed metadiscourse before? Metadiscourse happens when you write about your own writing or your experience of writing or your thoughts on your writing in your writing.
- When is metadiscourse helpful and unhelpful?

→ REVIEW

- Look back at 2-3 of your narrations from this term. Do you tend to include metadiscourse? If you find an example of metadiscourse, try to rewrite the sentence without it. How does it sound different?
- Pick a current events article to read. Do you notice any metadiscourse? Keep an eye out for it this week!

WEEK 5

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 49

Point of View

→ WRITE

My Brother Sam is Dead is written from Tim's perspective (a 1st person POV). Retell Ch.V, VII, or another section from a different character's perspective. Then, retell the same selection from a

• REFERENCE

General Literature: Grades 9-10 (Lesson 31,33)

Book: My Brother Sam is Dead

Composition: Grade 10

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Term 2

3rd person (outside) POV. Here are examples to get you started:

1st Person POV (Tim's perspective): "I looked at my father."

1st Person POV (Tim's father's perspective): "Tim looked at me."

3rd person POV: (Narrator's perspective): "Tim looked at his father."

WEEK 5

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 50

Satire/Travel Writing

Option 1: Gulliver's Travels

→ DISCUSS

Remember that satire "mocks vice (wickedness) and folly (foolishness) in order to correct both" (Karen Swallow Prior in her introduction to *Sense & Sensibility*). What aspects of British culture does Jonathan Swift make fun of? Give one or two examples.

→ REFLECT

What are aspects of our culture today that you think need reform? Jot down any ideas you have for how you could write a satirical scene showing the ridiculousness of something today. (Note: it's easy to poke fun at things in a mean way; try to think of ways you could show the problem for what it is without meanness.)

Option 2: Travel Writing

Think back on some travels (short or long, near or far) that you took and write your own travel account. Think about the descriptions you include. Can you make your account vivid and memorable for your readers?

• REFERENCE

General Lit (Term 2, Weeks 1-5)

Book: Gulliver's Travels

OR

History of Lit (Lesson 17)

Book: Travel Writings (students do not need to have completed this lesson to use the prompt)

WEEK 5

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 51

Materials: Style: The Basics of Clarity & Grace

→ READ

p.44-47 "If you" - "to complexity."

→ NARRATE & DISCUSS

The Basics of Clarity and Grace packs a lot of ideas into just a few pages. Summarize the ideas from this chapter in your own words. Then spend about 10-15 minutes reflecting on Chapter 4 and today's reading in a different way. You could design a poster or a bookmark, write a poem, or something else entirely.

Note: You'll probably have a bit of extra time today. Enjoy!

WEEK 6

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 52

Essay-genre analysis

→ READ & WRITE

Dating back to Aristotle, many authors and playwrights visualize the shape of a story or play in five parts. Read about or review this 5-part structure, then think (and look) back over what you've read in *Much Ado About Nothing*. Is the play following this general arc? Where would you identify the introduction, rising action, and climax? Explain.

∞ Article Link: Five-Act Structure

∞ Article Link: Five-Act Opt. 2

→ NOTE

Remember when you learned that many pieces of writing are focused around a question? Notice how your entire piece today is focused around the question "Is the play following the general 5-part structure arc of a play?" That is your large question. Then notice the smaller questions that will help you answer that larger one: Where do you identify the introduction, rising action, and climax? You'll have another lesson time to work on this essay. There are many ways you could proceed, but here is one possibility (a classic five-paragraph essay):

- Introduction: Introduce the main question and write your answer in one sentence (your thesis).
- Paragraph: Where/do you see the standard features of an "introduction" in *Much Ado About Nothing*?
- Paragraph: Where/do you see the standard features of "rising action"?
- Paragraph: Where/do you see the standard features of a "climax"?
- Conclusion: Summarize your main points and give any additional thoughts about how the assignment helped you understand the play better, any additional questions you have, etc.

• REFERENCE

Plays/Shakespeare (Lesson 18)

Book: *Much Ado About Nothing*

WEEK 6

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 53

Poetry writing

→ WRITE

Try writing a poem about one of your readings (or rewrite a narration) in dactylic hexameter (Longfellow's meter).

• REFERENCE

Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 (Term 2)

Book: *Hiawatha* or *The Courtship of Miles Standish*

Composition: Grade 10

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Term 2

WEEK 6

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 54

Materials: Style: The Basics of Clarity & Grace

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.47-49 "In the last" - "intravenous feeding."
Review p.28-29 and p.40-41

→ READ

- Read 5 commonplace quotes and listen to where you hear the stress in each sentence. Write down your findings. Do you notice any patterns?
- Read a few sentences from 3-4 of your writing assignments aloud (choose older ones). Do you notice where you tend to place the stress in your sentences?

→ REVISE

Pick a few of your sentences to revise according to the instructions on p.49.

WEEK 7

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 55

Poetry - Comparison

→ REVIEW

What do you remember about found poetry?

→ WRITE

Create a found poem out of at least two different sources today. You could use two closely related sources, such as two different captivity narratives, travel memoirs, or diaries that you've read in History of Lit. Or you could pick two sources that contrast in some way (a captivity narrative and Celebrated Cases of Judge Dee, for instance, or a Bible passage and something in Architecture).

- Choose your two different specific passages (keep them short).
- Brainstorm why you think each source is interesting.
- Jot down similarities and differences between them.
- Jot down any new thoughts or questions you have because of the comparison.
- Highlight words or phrases in each of your selections that you like and that seem important to the passages.
- Put those words and phrases onto a separate document or sheet of paper.
- Start building your poem. Here you will have to decide the form and direction of your poem. You could write a stanza of your poem using one source, then a second using the other source, and then conclude it with a third stanza reflecting poetically on their similarities or differences and the new questions you have by putting them together. The main question to ask yourself is: "Why is it interesting to consider these two different sources together in the same poem?" Maybe they highlight the variety of things composed during the same time period. Or the way that people's experiences have similarities across time and space. Maybe they just raise questions for you.
- Keep writing your poem until the end of the lesson. You can use a revision lesson later in the term (or spend your own time) to refine your poem further if interested.

WEEK 7

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 56

Scene writing/ dialogue

→ INTRO

It's hard to get dialogue in a book to sound natural. Read these thoughts on writing dialogue.
∞ Article Link: Thoughts on Dialogue (stop at "other than stage direction.")

→ WRITE

Write a scene for a play from The Sand Reckoner, Jonathan Edwards' Bio, a Bible passage, Chasing Venus/The Race to Save the Lord God Bird, or another reading. Don't forget the instructions for the stage setup and any props! Feel free to look back at a Shakespeare play to remind yourself how to format/write a scene.

• REFERENCE

Ancient History: Grades 10-12
Church History: Grades 10-12
Geography: Grades 10-11
Bible

WEEK 7

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 57

Materials: Style: The Basics of Clarity & Grace

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.50-51

→ REVISE (SEE ANSWER KEY APPENDIX FOR SOLUTIONS)

1. Rewrite this sentence with a "there shift." "Various literary techniques enable writers to control the placement of key narrative elements within a sentence."
2. Rewrite this sentence with a "Passive shift." "Some experts propose that environmental factors shape aspects of personality that we typically associate with upbringing."
3. Rewrite the sentence with a "What shift." "We need more Charlotte Mason schools!"
4. Rewrite this sentence with an "It shift." That Joey should learn to whittle appeared necessary."
5. Rewrite this sentence with a "Not only X but (also) Y (as well)" structure. "You should read more books and spend more time outside!"

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Term 2

NOTE: This lesson is a bit shorter than the time allotted. Spend extra time catching up on other assignments or take a break!

WEEK 8

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 58

Poetry

→ WRITE

Write a narration (or pick a previous narration to rewrite) in blank verse. Remember that this is Milton's preferred style for *Paradise Lost*!

WEEK 8

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 59

Revision

→ WRITE

Continue working on your essay on *Much Ado About Nothing* from Lesson 52. Finish drafting your essay if it's still in process. (Look back at the play since you'll likely have fresh ideas now that you're a little further along!)

Big-Picture Revision

1. Are there other ideas you've had more recently that you'd like to add to your essay? Do that now.
2. Look at your paragraphs. Are they indented and focused around one idea each? Describe that main idea in one sentence and consider making that the first sentence of your paragraph.
3. Try moving your body paragraphs around in a different order. What order do you think might make the most sense to someone reading your words?

• REFERENCE

Plays/Shakespeare (Term 2)

Book: *Much Ado About Nothing*

WEEK 8

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 60

Materials: Style: The Basics of Clarity & Grace

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.52-55

→ REVISE

Apply the concepts you've learned in Chapter 5 to your essay on *Much Ado* from Lessons 52 and 59.

Sentence-Level Revision

1. Read your essay aloud and fix any grammar or spelling errors you hear or see.
2. Use Grammarly or another spell checker to find any other punctuation or spelling issues and fix those.
3. Look for wordiness. Are there any unnecessary words? Do you have any sentences that are very long that you could make into two shorter sentences? Long sentences have their place, but usually, shorter sentences are clearer.
4. Make main characters the subjects of sentences and make important actions verbs wherever possible.
5. How well do your sentences flow? Put old information before new information in your sentences.
6. Revise your sentences to put the stress where you want it. Think particularly about the beginnings and endings of your sentences.

WEEK 9

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 61

Tracing Character

→ WRITE

How has Tim changed throughout *My Brother Sam is Dead*? Look back at your book and see if you can identify a few concrete examples showing how Tim has changed in his actions and/or thoughts. What was he like at the beginning of the book? What is he like now? Then write up your findings. Be sure to make the first sentence of each paragraph your topic sentence and give supporting details in the others.

• REFERENCE

General Lit: Grades 9-10

Book: *My Brother Sam is Dead*

WEEK 9

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 62

Outline & Comparison/Description

→ WRITE

Compare and contrast the Declaration of Independence with the Declaration of the Rights of Man. Jot down a list of similarities and a list of differences.

∞ Article Link: Declaration of the Rights of Man

∞ Article Link: Declaration of Independence

• REFERENCE

General Lit (Lesson 40)

WEEK 9

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 63

Materials: Style: The Basics of Clarity & Grace

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

"Motivation" p.55-69

Composition: Grade 10

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Term 2

- In your own words, summarize a few of the key ingredients to an effective introduction.
- Now summarize a few of the key ingredients to an effective conclusion.
- What new ideas did you find in this chapter?

WEEK 10 **40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 64** *Compare & Contrast*

→ WRITE

Pick two or three different aspects to compare and contrast in a few of these different worlds: Archimedes' world, British North America, Indigenous North America, 17th-18th century Europe, or 17th century Korea. You will have two lessons to work on your comparison and contrast. Feel free to look back at your books as you develop your ideas!

After you finish comparing and contrasting, write a thesis for your paper summarizing your main points and argument.

• **REFERENCE**
History Topics

WEEK 10 **40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 65** *Revision*

→ REVISE

Choose either your found poem from two sources (Lesson 55) or blank verse narration (Lesson 58) to revise today.

Revising poetry is a little different than revising an essay, but there are so few words in a poem (compared to a whole book or essay) that it makes each word even more important.

1. Revisit the rules of the form you're using (if applicable).
2. Read your poem aloud. Are there any grammar or spelling errors to fix?
3. Does your poem follow the rules of its form? (Rhyme, meter, etc.) If you are breaking any of the rules, decide if you are breaking them for a reason to make a point or if you need to work on finding a different word to fit the rhyme scheme or meter.
4. Look back at your source documents or narration that your poem is based on. Is there anything you didn't get into the poem the first time that you want to add? Delete?
5. Think about the flow of the ideas and images in your poem. Is there a better way to organize them? Does your poem have a logical flow?
6. Imagery and metaphor are important in nearly all poems. What images and comparisons does your poem use, and are there any others that might capture an image or idea even more vividly? Think of at least two other images or comparisons you could use and try them out. Decide which is best and keep that.
7. Jot down a few things you want your reader to walk away thinking or feeling after hearing your poem. Go read your poem aloud to someone (or two!) and ask them what their initial impressions are. If they are completely different than what you intended, consider what you might want to alter so that your purpose comes through more clearly.

WEEK 10 **40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 66**

Materials: Style: The Basics of Clarity & Grace

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**
p.70-78 "The two" - "feel lost."

→ WRITE

Spend the part of your lesson continuing to write your compare/contrast paper from Lesson 64. Consider how to build global coherence in your structure.

WEEK 11 **40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 67** *Summarize & Opinion*

→ WRITE

Summarize Sam's argument for the Patriot cause and Mr. Meeker's argument against it. List several key spots in the book showing their perspectives and cite the page number as you learned in Essay Voyage. Focus on this part today.

Next Lesson: Now that you're almost at the end of the book, what is your opinion? Do you think the war was worth it? Can you imagine another way the United States could have achieved freedom?

• **REFERENCE**
General Literature: Grades 9-10
Book: My Brother Sam is Dead

WEEK 11 **40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 68** *Summary/Opinion cont.*

→ WRITE

Continue working on your assignment on My Brother Sam is Dead from the last lesson. Focus on writing your opinion and reasons during this lesson and save some time to look over your work to correct any obvious errors.

• **REFERENCE**
General Literature: Grades 9-10
Book: My Brother Sam is Dead

Composition: Grade 10

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Term 2

After you finish writing your analysis, write a thesis that sums up your opinion and reasoning and put it at the beginning of your assignment. Make sure each of your paragraphs have clear topic sentences.

WEEK 11 **40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 69**

Revision: Compare/Contrast

Materials: Style: The Basics of Clarity & Grace

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**

p.78-81 "This basic" - end of chapter.

→ **REVISE**

Keep the ideas of global coherence in mind as you revise your essay comparing the various worlds you're reading about in history.

Big-Picture/Global Revision

1. Are there other ideas you've had more recently that you'd like to add to your compare/contrast essay? Do that now.
2. Does your introduction include the main question and topic you are trying to address, along with your thesis?
3. Look at your paragraphs. Are they indented and focused around one idea each? Describe that main idea in one sentence and consider making that the first sentence of your paragraph.
4. Do your paragraphs flow well? Experiment with moving your key comparisons/contrasts in a different order. Which makes the most sense?

Sentence-Level Revision

1. Read your paper aloud and fix any grammar errors you hear and see.
2. Use Grammarly or another spell checker to find any other punctuation or spelling issues and fix those.
3. Give your essay a title
4. Make main characters the subjects of sentences and important actions verbs where possible.
5. How well do your sentences flow? Put old information before new information in your sentences.
6. Delete unnecessary words and change negatives to affirmatives.
7. Make sure your sentences are complete, not fragments.
8. Make sure your essay is consistently in 3rd person.

WEEK 12 **40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 70**

Exam Week

→ **EXAMS**

Answer question(s) related to course.

WEEK 12 **40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 71**

Exam Week

→ **EXAMS**

Answer question(s) related to course.

WEEK 12 **40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 72**

Exam Week

→ **EXAMS**

Answer question(s) related to course.

Composition: Grade 10

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Term 3

WEEK 1

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 73 *Essay*

→ WRITE

What are some big ideas or themes that you have seen consistently across your readings in Turning Points and/or Jonathan Edwards' bio for Church history?

• REFERENCE

Church History: Grades 10-12
Book: Turning Points/Jonathan Edwards' Bio

WEEK 1

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 74 *Compare & Contrast*

→ WRITE

Pick one or two specific passages or verses from your Bible reading in the gospels. Look up the same passage in at least three different translations of the Bible. Then write an essay comparing and contrasting the different imagery and how the emphases come out differently. Biblegateway.com is a good online resource to use to compare translations if you do not have three different physical translations in your house.

OR

Compare and contrast the beginnings of the Iliad, Odyssey, and Paradise Lost. Think about the fact that Milton claimed he was writing a more "epic" epic than Homer.

∞ PDF Link: Iliad Selections PDF

• REFERENCE

New Testament
Book: NIV Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, any other translations you like!

Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 (Term 1 & Term 3)

Book: Paradise Lost, The Odyssey

WEEK 1

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 75

Materials: Style: The Basics of Clarity & Grace

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.82-85 "I spare" - "of chess."

→ REVISE

Pick an older narration or writing assignment to revise. Make sure it's typed up (or do that now). Then go through each sentence and see how many meaningless, doubled, or redundant words you can remove.

Remember: the point is to cut out unnecessary words, not to say as little as possible about your topic. Details are important, but not all words convey them.

WEEK 2

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 76 *Scene Writing*

→ WRITE

Write a section from Pride & Prejudice, A Tale of Two Cities, or The Odyssey (or another book of your choice) as a short play. You'll have two lesson periods to focus on this. Today, focus on sketching out the big picture. How many scenes will you include? (Remember, scenes can be short.) What will you focus on in each scene? What extra characters will you invent? Look at one of Shakespeare's plays or another play you've read to remind yourself how to format your writing.

Once you have a general idea of how you want your play to go (of course, you'll tweak things as you go), start writing!

Here is one example of how someone else turned part of Pride & Prejudice into a play. Only read if you're ok with spoilers though!

∞ PDF Link: Scenes by Pertwee

• REFERENCE

General Lit (Term 3)
Book: Pride & Prejudice or A Tale of Two Cities

Poetry Reading (Term 3)

Book: The Odyssey

WEEK 2

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 77 *Playwriting and revision*

→ WRITE & REVISE

Continue writing your play. Save at least 10 minutes at the end to review and edit.

1. Check punctuation, grammar, and spelling with your own eyes and a spell checker.
2. Read your dialogue aloud and revise. Does it sound natural? Remember that we tend to speak in shorter sentences and fragments.
3. Add instructions for props as desired.
4. Make sure you indicate the setting for each scene (i.e., the front yard of a house, a boat, etc.).
5. Write a summary of each scene (if you have multiple), describing what happens in it.
6. Make a plan to have some friends perform your play!

• REFERENCE

General Lit (Term 3)
Book: Pride & Prejudice or A Tale of Two Cities

Poetry Reading (Term 3)

Book: The Odyssey

WEEK 2

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 78

Materials: Style: The Basics of Clarity & Grace

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.85-88 "Replace a phrase" - "and adverbs."

→ CREATE

Turn the six rules of concision into a poster or a bookmark. Sketch by hand and/or create a design in Canva or another software.

Term 3

WEEK 3

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 79 *Revision*

→ REVISE

Pick a previous narration that is at least two paragraphs long to revise and rewrite. Spend most of your time on sentence-level revisions today and practice concision.

Big-Picture Revision

1. If you have not already typed your narration, do that now so you have a digital version to edit.
2. Are there other ideas you've had more recently that you'd like to add to your narration? Do that now.
3. Look at your paragraphs. Are they indented and focused around one idea each? Describe that main idea in one sentence and consider making that the first sentence of your paragraph.
4. Try moving your paragraphs around in a different order. What order do you think might make the most sense to someone reading your words?

Sentence-Level Revision

1. Read your narration aloud and fix any grammar or spelling errors you hear or see. Then use Grammarly to find any additional errors.
2. How well do your sentences flow? Put old information before new information in your sentences.
3. Delete words that mean little or nothing.
4. Delete redundant words.
5. Delete words implied by other words.
6. Replace a phrase with a word.
7. Change negatives to affirmatives.
8. Delete useless adjectives and adverbs.

Share your revised narration with someone.

WEEK 3

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 80 *Technology/visual*

→ INTRO

Have you incorporated visual sketches into your narrations at all this year? There are so many ways to see words and stories with colors, shapes, and pictures, in addition to just reading words on a page (think of picture books!). Depending on the topic, one way of communicating might be better than another. A birthday party invitation looks much better on a colorful poster than written as a paragraph. On the flip side, paragraphs are essential to a longer book or story.

→ CREATE

Make a poster, infographic, a mind map, or any other sort of visual from your reading that you'd like to see another way. Use one of the ideas below or come up with your own. Draw or model it in 3-D by hand first, if desired, and if there is time left, try creating it with Canva.

- Events in Jesus' life from your reading in the gospels
- Character map from *Pride & Prejudice*, Shakespeare, or another reading
- Something from Science
- Connections between different books you've read this year
- Structure of Colossians
- Something from History or Geography

WEEK 3

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 81

Materials: Style: The Basics of Clarity & Grace

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.89-93

→ REVISE

Rewrite each sentence to minimize metadiscourse. Additionally, work to make characters subjects and actions verbs. Note: there is no answer key for this exercise, as a variety of revisions are acceptable!

1. To begin with, it is important to note that, as we shall see, reading books regularly can significantly enhance one's cognitive abilities and overall knowledge base.
2. In other words, what we are essentially arguing here is that the immersive experience of reading novels, in fact, plays a crucial role in developing empathy and understanding different perspectives.
3. It is worth mentioning, therefore, that according to numerous studies, the correlation between reading fiction and improved emotional intelligence, as previously discussed, remains a widely accepted theory.
4. As a matter of fact, let us not forget that, in light of recent educational research, the habit of reading books, as argued by many educators, is fundamental to academic success.
5. To put it simply, one could argue that the enjoyment and relaxation derived from reading books, which, as it turns out, are often underestimated, contribute greatly to mental well-being.

Composition: Grade 10

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Term 3

WEEK 4	40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 82 <i>POV - 1st Person</i> → WRITE Compose a letter to someone in history or to a character in a book, telling them something interesting you read in one of your books and your thoughts about it	• REFERENCE History
WEEK 4	40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 83 <i>Style</i> → WRITE Write about something you've read, experienced, or imagined in the style of another author (living or dead). Read your work to someone and see if they can guess the author you're trying to imitate!	• REFERENCE History
WEEK 4	40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 84 Materials: Style: The Basics of Clarity & Grace → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p.94-102 • Explain how the idea of simple-before-complex applies to paragraphs, a section of a document, and an entire document. → REVIEW • Pick 5-10 commonplace quotes with long sentences and read them aloud. Notice where you stop to breathe. • Pick 2-3 of your own narrations (or a friend's if possible), identify a few long sentences and read them aloud. Do you experience breathlessness or get a sensation of lurching from one idea to another? • Pick 2-3 of your books from the term, and read a paragraph or two aloud. Stop when you come to a long sentence. Examine the sentence. Does it follow the principles you read?	
WEEK 5	40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 85 <i>Essay</i> → WRITE Write a character sketch of Cato or Hal in Henry IV based on Shakespeare's depiction of him so far. Who is he, and what are some of his key motivations and characteristics? Use examples from the play to show your thoughts. OR Write an essay on hospitality in the Odyssey so far. Give specific examples (and the line numbers) from the story to show your point.	• REFERENCE Plays: Grades 9-12/Shakespeare (Lesson 29) Book: Cato or Henry IV Part 1 OR Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 (Lesson 55)
WEEK 5	40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 86 <i>Outline</i> → WRITE Outline a couple of the chapters you have read so far in Turning Points (Church History) or one of your Citizenship readings. (Remember, an outline is just a list of the key points from each chapter. It is often done in a bullet-point format.)	• REFERENCE Church History Book: Turning Points OR Citizenship
WEEK 5	40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 87 Materials: Style: The Basics of Clarity & Grace → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p.102-109 "When we" - "more complex." → REVISE Pick a narration to revise and focus on the shape of your sentences. Work to use each shaping technique you've learned.	
WEEK 6	40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 88 <i>Poetry</i> → WRITE Write or rewrite a narration as a poem (your choice of form, meter, and rhyme scheme). Add a note with the poetic form you chose to use.	
WEEK 6	40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 89 <i>PowerPoint/ Google Slides</i> → CREATE • Create a PowerPoint to accompany a previous narration or writing assignment.	

Composition: Grade 10

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Term 3

- Share it with someone.

Remember:

∞ Article Link: Rules for PowerPoints

WEEK 6

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 90

Materials: Style: The Basics of Clarity & Grace

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.109-113 "Even when" - end of chapter.

→ WRITE

Try composing a few different types of coordinating sentences, and use the extra time in this lesson to catch up on other assignments or just enjoy a shorter day!

★ STUDENT TIP

Plan to keep Style: The Basics of Clarity and Grace on your shelf as a reference as you continue through high school!

WEEK 7

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 91

Description

→ WRITE

Describe a scene you've read or seen (or imagined). Work to show rather than tell. Include details for all five senses.

WEEK 7

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 92

Sentence Structure

→ READ & REFLECT

Learn about how Jane Austen uses sentence structure and then look at *Pride & Prejudice* and a few other books. Jot down your findings. Can you see any patterns in how the characters talk in *Pride & Prejudice*? How would you describe the sentence style of other writers you look at? Do they tend to write long or short sentences? Use a lot of descriptive words? Notice any other examples of dialogue. Continue paying attention to sentence structure as you read.

∞ Article Link: Sentence Structure

→ WRITE

With remaining time, write a dialogue between two characters and try to show what they are like through your sentence structure.

WEEK 7

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 93

Materials: Style: The Basics of Clarity & Grace

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.114-119

→ WRITE

Use the sample sentences in the lesson as a template to try composing your own.

→ EXPLORE

The type of structure called a "Chiasmus" is common in the Bible.

∞ Article Link: Chiasms

WEEK 8

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 94

Essay - Characterization

→ WRITE

Do you think Odysseus changes after his misadventures? Give reasons from your reading and cite line numbers.

• REFERENCE

Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 (Lesson 63)

Book: The Odyssey

WEEK 8

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 95

POV - 1st Person

→ WRITE

Pretend you are Mr. Darcy and write a diary entry describing the Netherfield ball.

OR

Imagine you are Mr. Collins and write a diary entry describing your proposal to Elizabeth.

• REFERENCE

General Literature: Grades 9-10 (Term 3)

Book: *Pride & Prejudice*

WEEK 8

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 96

Materials: Style: The Basics of Clarity & Grace

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.120-130

Composition: Grade 10

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Term 3

→ WRITE

Use the examples in your reading as a template, and compose sentences in the formats described.

WEEK 9

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 97

Revision

→ REVISE

Pick a previous narration or writing assignment that is at least two paragraphs long to revise and turn into a longer essay. Your character sketch on Richard Hal or Cato would be a good option.

Big-Picture Writing & Revision

- If you have not already typed your narration, do that now so you have a digital version to edit.
- Plan out your outline for your intro, body, and conclusion. Reread sections of the book you're drawing from to identify any additional examples you'd like to use.

WEEK 9

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 98

Revision

→ REVISE

Continue working on your essay from Lesson 97.

Sentence-Level Revision

1. Read your essay aloud and fix any grammar or spelling errors you hear or see.
2. Use Grammarly or another spell checker to find any other punctuation or spelling issues and fix those.
3. Make main characters the subjects of sentences and important actions verbs where possible.
4. How well do your sentences flow? Put old information before new information in your sentences.
5. Delete unnecessary words and change negatives to affirmatives.
6. Read your final draft aloud again. Listen to the stress and structure of your sentences and revise.

Share your essay with someone.

WEEK 9

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 99

Materials: Style: The Basics of Clarity & Grace

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.131-140 end at "it's not."

- What are your thoughts or reactions on this section about the ethics of writing? Write an extended narration on the topic. Include examples where you've seen writers use language to obscure or misdirect, questions, connections you see to ideas in other subjects.

WEEK 10

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 100

Reflection

→ WRITE

Write down questions you have about writing. Where do you think you have improved? Where do you think you need to grow? What about writing is the most fun, most confusing, easiest, and hardest?

Discuss with your teacher.

WEEK 10

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 101

Questions

→ WRITE

Write as many questions as you can during the time about one or a few different books (and/or the connections between them). Then circle the ones that you're particularly curious about.

WEEK 10

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 102

Materials: Style: The Basics of Clarity & Grace

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.140-150 "It is easy" - "of mind."

- Summarize the authors' analysis of Jefferson's writing. What are your thoughts on the questions they raise at the end of the chapter?

WEEK 11

40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 103

Essay - Character Sketch/Opinion

→ WRITE

What do you think makes a true hero according to Homer? Do you agree with him?

• REFERENCE

Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12
(Term 3)

Book: The Odyssey

Composition: Grade 10

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

OR

Write a character sketch of Odysseus. What is he like? What are his chief characteristics?

WEEK 11 **40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 104**

Revision

→ **REVISE**

Revise and edit your character sketch on Hal or Cato.

Big-Picture Revision

1. Are there other ideas you've had more recently that you'd like to add to your narration? Do that now.
2. Look at your paragraphs. Are they indented and focused around one idea each? Describe that main idea in one sentence and consider making that the first sentence of your paragraph.
3. Try moving your paragraphs around in a different order. What order do you think might make the most sense to someone reading your words?
4. Consider formatting your character sketch as an essay with an intro, body, and conclusion (not required).

Sentence-Level Revision

1. Read your narration aloud and fix any grammar or spelling errors you hear or see.
2. Use Grammarly or another spell checker to find any other punctuation or spelling issues and fix those.
3. Make main characters the subjects of sentences and important actions verbs where possible.
4. How well do your sentences flow? Put old information before new information in your sentences.
5. Delete unnecessary words and change negatives to affirmatives.
6. Read your work aloud again and revise to improve the shape and structure of your sentences.

Share your revised character sketch assignment with someone.

WEEK 11 **40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 105**

Catch Up Day

→ **CATCH UP**

Use this time to catch up on lessons in this or another course, or explore Extra Helpings.

WEEK 12 **40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 106**

Exam Week

→ **EXAMS**

Answer question(s) related to the course.

WEEK 12 **40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 107**

Exam Week

→ **EXAMS**

Answer question(s) related to the course.

WEEK 12 **40m Composition: Grade 10 - Lesson 108**

Exam Week

→ **EXAMS**

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Composition: Grade 10

Examination

Term 1

- Style: The Basics of Clarity & Grace: What is the purpose of editing and revision? Give examples of ways to improve sentences.

- **Choose one:**

- Write a scene or a conversation about something you've read or experienced. Pay particular attention to your dialogue and make it sound as natural as possible.
- Choose 3 books you've read this term. If the book is the answer to a question, what is the question behind each of these three books?
- Write a description or narration in the style of someone else (a friend or another author like Shakespeare). Include the name of the person you're imitating at the end of your work.

Term 2

- Style: The Basics of Clarity & Grace: What are cohesion and coherence in writing? What can you do to build it into your writing?

- Write a poem about something you've observed in nature and use descriptive and detailed language that immerses your readers in the scene. Try to include details for all five senses!

Term 3

- Style: The Basics of Clarity & Grace: Name as many as you can of the six rules of concision.

- Design a poster (by hand or in Canva) describing the editing process and what to work on at each stage.